

Worker in that he believed in earning income through his own personal exertion—and lots of it.

The danger for Tony and Worker Money Types like him is they can become a ‘wage slave’, even if they’re self-employed. (By a wage slave I mean they’re trapped in or tied to their jobs because they have no other investments or income streams.) That’s because they prioritise their wage or their ability to earn an income and don’t necessarily invest because they lack the confidence or the time. So, while they may earn a good income through their willingness to work hard, this doesn’t necessarily equate to substantial assets generated. In fact, many Workers will have the same or less assets than other Money Types despite feeling like they’ve worked harder, which can lead Workers to feel frustrated and discouraged.

When Tony and I started a relationship, in 2006, he had a fairly large sum of money in a savings bank account that he’d been intending for years to use as a deposit for a home. The problem was he was too busy working to really do anything about it. I also suspect he wasn’t convinced where to buy and didn’t have time to research alternatives. Because he lacked time and confidence, he stopped looking and defaulted to working instead because that was generating a good income, which meant he didn’t need to panic about buying assets. This ability to earn income is both a strength and a weakness for a Worker. It can be an Achilles’ heel if the Worker defaults to relying solely on earning an income and not building assets.

Tony, however, did have some assets other than cash in the bank. When he bought in to the physiotherapy partnership he also bought part of the building. That’s because he understood the business and the location, and he understood that paying rent to himself rather than a landlord made sense. He didn’t need to spend time researching or analysing and in doing this could develop an asset other than simply cash. In other words, it ticked the Worker’s boxes of a safe, understood and easy investment.

Tony also had outstanding income tax returns when we met. He had outsourced them to an accountant, assumed they would be completed and forgot about them. Unfortunately for Tony, the accountant didn’t lodge his returns and dropped the ball. Tony had recognised his need to outsource, which is a great money habit for a Worker, but hadn’t put in place checks to ensure the person he’d outsourced to was doing their job. Tony’s default is typical of many Workers: to work and hope that everything else sorts itself out.